Conestogo Public School – Council Minutes: Wednesday, November 03, 2021

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UPCOMING COUNCIL EVENTS

2020-21 Event Dates:

Next Council Meeting: November 17

- December 15
- January 19
- February 16
- March 23 (Adjusted FOR MARCH BREAK)
- April 20
- May 18
- June 15

ACTION ITEM SUMMARY

Initiative/Project	Action Item	Person Responsible
Cross Walk	Create a survey to send to parents about preferred crossing location	Gena
Cross Walk	Draft letter to the Board to advocate for moving the crossing location	Ian

WELCOME & GENERAL BUSINESS

Attendance

(P present, N absent/regrets. Parent Members must attend 70% of meetings to maintain voting privileges.)

Role	2020-2021	Sep 29	Nov 3	Nov 17	Dec 15	Jan 19	Feb 16	Mar 23	Apr 20
Co-Chair	Colleen Heinrichs	P	P						
Co-Chair	Rebecca Hallman	P	P						
Treasurer	Karen Hofbauer	P	P						
Communications	Jenny Benham	P	N						
Communications	Gena Braun	P	P						
Secretary	Ian Howlett	P	P						
Principal	Michael Sendrea	P	P						
Teacher Reps	Various Staff	Shannon Brown	Dougall Newport						
Community	n/a	n/a	n/a						
WRAPSC	Jessica Gordon	P	P						
Parent Members & Volunteers	Cori Algeier	P	N						
	Christine Sanchez	P	N						
	Erin Schmidt	P	P						
	Lynn Ferguson	P	N						
	Agnes Lehtonen	N	N						
	Karen Forsyth	P	P						
	Steph Forte	N	P						
	Sheri Albert	N	P						

Agenda – Review & Approval

Adjustments to Agenda: • Nutrition Break – What Activities	**Agenda approval with changes motioned by:** **1st: Jessica** **2nd: Gena**

Minutes, May– Review & Approval

Adjustments to Minutes: •	**Minutes approval with changes motioned by:** **1st: Ian** **2nd: Rebecca**

PRESENTATIONS

Teacher's Report – Ms. Newport

- We are continuing to move forward on getting things back to normal
    - On Monday we can go back into Art/Music/Health room
    - Opens activities that can be done with the students

Principal's Report – Mr. Sendrea

- Apologies to everyone for delaying the October 20th meeting to today
    - Was on phone calls all night dealing with confirmed case of COVID-19
- We had one case of COVID-19 confirmed which also caused issues with the bus
- Following Sunday an additional case was confirmed and then another in the same class as the previous week
- This caused an outbreak to be declared which caused the cohorts in the classroom and the bus to be dismissed for remote learning
- As of today, all the teachers and children are back in the classroom
- All the bussed students were brought into the gym to have a reminder about staying in your assigned seat, wearing your mask, and keeping the volume low
- **Question**: Did the parents have complaints about confusion around messaging from Public Health?
    - **Answer**: Improvement is needed in the way communication flows. It flows from Public Health to the Board to the Principal and then to the parents

  - Should there be a contradiction between the school and Public Health, the parent can side with the direction from public health
- Closing in on the Christmas holidays
- Students are doing well and enjoying being back in person
- Extracurricular activities are starting up gradually
  - Funtastic Fridays are starting with the Grade 7/8 students
  - Athletic council will also be starting
- We are going to be remaining cautious
- Volunteers are going to be starting up, but the processes are still being ironed out
  - Strong Start is a priority to help the students
- Individual Education Plans are in the process of going home right now to be reviewed and signed
- Mr. Budafalvi has started Early Learning Intervention (ELI) to help students who need assistance in reading
- Progress reports for Grades 1-8 on the way
  - K students will get Initial Observations of Learning
- Special Education teachers (Mr. Budafalvi and Ms. McWhirter) are assessing behavioural needs along with the Occupational Therapist (OT)
- New Director of Education came for a visit recently
- October 29th events were still able to be enjoyed by the students while keeping in with the guidance from the Board
- Remembrance Day we are planning a fairly small live stream that will be produced by three classes

School & Road Safety / Cross Walk / Crossing Guards – Sheri Albert

- There is a lot of traffic some days, but it is sporadic
- There was a near accident when a dump truck ran the corner on Evening Star Lane near the school
- There are many people on their phones (witnessed 10 in a 30-minute shift that were obvious)
- The lights at Northfield are very close to the crosswalk, resulting in cars speeding up quite a bit to make the light and signalling even before the lights
- Even parents in the community are falling into the same bad behaviour of using their phones while driving on Sawmill
- Detour sign is disruptive to the vision of the crossing guard on the South side of Sawmill
- Cars do not generally follow the rules of the island divider, meaning they do not stop on both sides of the island when stopping for children/crossing guards
- **Question:** Is there a reason why kids are not crossing from Northfield intersection?

  - **Answers**: Most families are coming from the Glasgow side of the road, rather than Northfield
- The school has been at contact with the Region and there hasn't been an appetite to move the crosswalk
- There was work done with speed cameras but CPS was not deemed as eligible
- **Question:** Who would make the decision on adding a crossing guard to the lights at Northfield?
  - **Answer**: The Region makes the decisions around location of crossing guards but the school would have a say
- **Action Item**: Create a survey to send to parents about crossing location and draft a letter to the Region

STANDING AGENDA ITEMS

WRAPSC Report – Jessica

- Information for Pro Grants should be coming out in the next two weeks and will be due in the middle of December
- Even though they allocated all of the money last year schools did not spend it all
- They are considering changing the allocation so that it will be based on the socioeconomic factors of the school
- They are encouraging schools to work with other nearby schools and will only approve virtual activities at this point
- One of the big focuses is Inclusion and Anti-Racism, so those projects will get looked at more favourably
- With regards to fundraising, the principals are given the call from the Board on what is acceptable for that school
- Some schools are getting around some of the restrictions around COVID-19 protocols by managing their fundraising activities off site
- They won't specify what is allowed and what isn't, but advise parent groups to work closely with their principals
- **Question:** Who were the speakers about the fundraising and COVID-19 restrictions?
  - **Answer:** Matt Gerard, the coordinating Superintendent
- The nutrition programs that have been running have not been offering non-packaged foods and such over the pandemic for lower income schools
- Lunch programs are not on any agendas to discuss yet
- Pizza days are being enjoyed in Catholic boards, but the Public board has not decided to restart those kinds of activities
- Matt suggested when you are looking at fundraising you should look at a specific guidance from the Board on what you can use fundraising for (example: no technology that isn't fixed) (https://www.wrdsb.ca/wp-

content/uploads/4690-School-Generated-Funds.pdf Fundraising, AP 4690)

Treasurer's Report – Karen

- Our current budget draft is not balanced, but we can revise it based on decisions around the Playground
- We would like to figure out how to use the budget before further restrictions on what the playground equipment we can use will be
- We continue to have a $5000 carry over as part of the budget in order to ensure we have money to cover other fundraising activities
- If we want to have a balanced budget, we would end up being short just over $6000 to build what we want to build by the end of the year
- WEFI is the charitable organization set-up for the Board in case parents want to donate funds https://www.wrdsb.ca/wefi/
- Notes from the budget incoming
    - Silent Auction and Mabels Labels intended to make the same as last year
    - Lunches will hopefully bring in some funds into the Spring of next year
    - Possibility to run Christmas Flowers off site as discussed earlier
    - FlipGive expected to make slightly less this year due to Amazon leaving the service
    - New initiatives for Dinner on the Run and Maple Syrup sales
    - May be restarting the Lions Bingo night if restrictions allow it
- Expenditures
    - Gym equipment budget is holding around $500
    - No item for Recess set aside, same as last year
    - Hoping to provide a good portion of the Dreambox licenses
    - No funds set aside for Kodaly since we already purchased music that was unused
    - Most other expenses are holding from last year's costs
- MOTION to pass the budget
    - Karen First
    - Gena Seconded
    - Motion has passed

Safe, Caring, Inclusive, and Healthy Schools Committee – Mr. Sendrea

- The committee has not been struck or met

COMMITTEES & EVENTS – STATUS REPORTS

Fundraising for 2021-2022 – Fundraising Committee - Gena

- Food Truck activities are set to make around $450
- Some schools are doing a pizza night by partnering with local pizza shops to have an offer code that helps the schools take a cut
- We need to decide on the poinsettias and Christmas urns soon to move forward before the holidays
- MOTION to run the above fundraiser
  - First Rebecca
  - Second Gena
  - Motion passed on condition of someone volunteering from the parent members to run the event

Virtual Auction Update - Erin

- The letters are out and the spreadsheets are out so we should have what we need to start getting donations
- Spreadsheet for the auction is here: https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1kEdwFmd3OOpTkZ2b70mjArizlHP7TSleZYZEp_C6xuY/edit?usp=sharing

Playground Update – Rebecca, Colleen, Katie

- Discussions still ongoing to get commitments for what/when we are building the additional playground equipment
- We are working with Alex Ramirez (replacing Barry Kingsley) from the Board
- For additional funding we are not expecting any from the Township
- Grade 8 graduation committee formation, if there are any interested teachers and parents we should be gathering them to start that committee
  - Mr. Sendrea is advising to delay a bit longer since there has been no guidance from the Board yet
- Next council meeting we can discuss having a meeting with the Principal to discuss other issues

OPEN DISCUSSION ITEMS

Nutrition Break Activities

- We had put money in the budget to give the kids balls and such

- **Question**: Are they being used by the students?
    - **Answer**: Students are allowed to share classroom items so we will check in with teachers to see if they have what they need

ADJOURNMENT

Motioned by:
1st: Colleen
2nd: Karen H